

PART A:

Case Study: Identity Theft

Identity theft is a cybercrime in which a criminal steals a person's personal information and uses it to commit fraud or other illegal activities. This information may include Aadhaar numbers, bank account details, passwords, or social media credentials.

A common identity theft scenario begins when a victim receives a fake email, message, or phone call pretending to be from a trusted source such as a bank or government agency. The victim is asked to click on a link or provide personal details for verification. Once the victim shares this information, the attacker collects and stores it. In the next step, the criminal uses the stolen identity to access bank accounts, make unauthorized transactions, or create fake accounts. Sometimes, attackers also use public Wi-Fi or phishing websites to capture login credentials without the user's knowledge.

Identity theft often targets students, elderly people, and individuals who are less aware of online safety practices. People who frequently use online services without proper security measures are also at higher risk.

The consequences of identity theft can be severe, including financial loss, damage to reputation, and emotional stress. Victims may also face difficulty in recovering their accounts or proving their identity. Therefore, it is important to protect personal information and stay alert while using digital platforms.

PART B:

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

1. Never share your OTP, passwords, or PIN with anyone, even if they claim to be from your bank.
2. Always verify links before clicking—avoid unknown or suspicious URLs sent via SMS, email, or WhatsApp.
3. Use strong and unique passwords for all accounts, and change them regularly.

4. Enable two-factor authentication on important apps like email, banking, and social media.
5. Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking or entering sensitive information.
6. Do not accept unknown UPI “collect requests” without verifying the sender.
7. Remember: You never need to enter your UPI PIN to receive money—only to send money.
8. Install apps only from trusted sources like Google Play Store or Apple App Store.

UPI / Financial Safety Tips

- Regularly update your phone and apps to stay protected from security vulnerabilities.
- Log out from shared devices and avoid saving passwords on public computers.

Report Cybercrime:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Helpline Number: 1930